

# GNOME Desktop Cheat-Sheet

## GNOME desktop cheat-sheet

Windows-like GNOME setup: dash-to-panel taskbar (bottom), ArcMenu start menu, per-window Alt-Tab, edge snapping. All of it is applied by the `gnome-nord` script – re-run it and re-login if anything looks stock.

### Start menu & apps

| Key                     | Action                                    |
|-------------------------|-------------------------------------------|
| <b>Super</b>            | Open start menu (ArcMenu, Windows layout) |
| Type after <b>Super</b> | Search apps/files, Enter to launch        |
| <b>Alt + F2</b>         | Run-command prompt (GNOME built-in)       |
| Taskbar icon click      | Focus/launch app (pin via right-click)    |

There are no custom app-launch hotkeys anymore (the old **Super+Q** etc. went with Hyprland). Add any you miss in Settings > Keyboard > Custom Shortcuts.

### Windows

| Key                       | Action                                             |
|---------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Alt + Tab</b>          | Switch between windows (Windows-style, per window) |
| <b>Super + Tab</b>        | Switch between applications (grouped)              |
| <b>Super + Left/Right</b> | Snap window to half screen (or drag to edge)       |
| <b>Super + Up</b>         | Maximize (or drag to top edge)                     |
| <b>Super + Down</b>       | Unmaximize / restore                               |
| <b>Super + H</b>          | Minimize (“hide”)                                  |
| <b>Alt + F4</b>           | Close window                                       |
| <b>F11</b>                | Fullscreen (app-dependent)                         |

### Workspaces

| Key                                        | Action                              |
|--------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| <b>Super + Page Up / Page Down</b>         | Previous / next workspace           |
| <b>Super + Shift + Page Up / Page Down</b> | Move window to prev/next workspace  |
| 3-finger touchpad swipe up                 | Overview (all windows + workspaces) |

### Media / system

Volume, brightness, and media keys are handled natively by GNOME. System menu (network, bluetooth, battery, power off): top-right of the taskbar. Lock screen: **Super + L**.

## Terminal apps

| Command | Action                                              |
|---------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| y       | yazi (in any terminal) – cds to wherever you exited |
| yazi    | yazi without the cd-on-exit behavior                |

## yazi keybinds

| Key              | Action                                                                      |
|------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| j / k or arrows  | Move down / up                                                              |
| h / l or arrows  | Parent dir / enter dir                                                      |
| H / L            | Back / forward in history                                                   |
| gg / G           | Top / bottom                                                                |
| gh               | Go home (~)                                                                 |
| gc               | Go to ~/.config                                                             |
| gd               | Go to ~/Downloads                                                           |
| <Space>          | Toggle selection on current file                                            |
| v / V            | Visual select mode / visual unset mode                                      |
| Ctrl+a / Ctrl+r  | Select all / invert selection                                               |
| y / x / p / P    | Yank (copy) / cut / paste / paste (overwrite)                               |
| d / D            | Trash / permanently delete                                                  |
| a                | Create file (end with / for a directory)                                    |
| r                | Rename                                                                      |
| o / Enter        | Open                                                                        |
| O / Shift+Enter  | Open interactively (pick app)                                               |
| .                | Toggle hidden files                                                         |
| / / ?            | Find next / previous                                                        |
| s / S            | Search by name (fd) / by content (ripgrep)                                  |
| f                | Filter files                                                                |
| tt               | New tab in current dir                                                      |
| 1-9              | Switch to tab N                                                             |
| [ / ]            | Previous / next tab                                                         |
| , then m/a/s/e/n | Sort by mtime / alphabetical / size / extension / natural (Shift = reverse) |
| w                | Task manager                                                                |
| ~ or F1          | Help (full keymap, searchable)                                              |
| q                | Quit                                                                        |

## GPU offload

Run any app on the NVIDIA dGPU instead of the AMD iGPU (GNOME always runs on AMD, since it drives the panel):

```
dgpu-run <command>
# e.g.
dgpu-run flatpak run org.prismlauncher.PrismLauncher
```

## WiFi

GNOME's system menu (top-right of the taskbar) lists and connects to networks. The `wifi` script still works from any terminal:

```
wifi                # interactive picker
wifi "GC Public"    # connect straight to a named network
```

Saved networks reconnect without a prompt; new ones ask for a password. On a captive portal you'll associate but have no route out until you open any `http://` page and sign in.

## Recovery

The login screen is SDDM (Nord-themed); GDM is installed but disabled as the fallback display manager.

- **Login screen black/broken (SDDM greeter fails):** switch to a TTY with `Ctrl+Alt+F3`, log in, run `sudo systemctl disable sddm && sudo systemctl enable gdm`, reboot. You're back on stock GDM; debug SDDM later from comfort.
- **GNOME session won't start / crashes at login:** from a TTY, check `journalctl --user -b -u org.gnome.Shell@wayland.service` (or `journalctl -b -p err`). `Ctrl+Alt+F1` (or `F2`) back to the graphical screen.
- **Session hung:** `loginctl terminate-user cross` from a TTY force-kills it and drops back to the login screen.
- **Theme/taskbar/start menu missing or stock-looking:** re-run `gnome-nord`, then log out/in. If `ArcMenu` is gone entirely (e.g. after a GNOME major upgrade breaks compatibility), reinstall the matching version from `extensions.gnome.org` (`gnome-extensions install <zip>`).
- **Desperate fallback session:** pick "GNOME Classic" at the login screen's session picker – ugly but always works. Normal logins should use plain "GNOME"; Classic force-loads its own extensions and fights this setup.